

TECHNICAL DESCRIPTION (PART B)

COVER PAGE

Part B of the Application Form must be downloaded from the Portal Submission System, completed and then assembled and re-uploaded as PDF in the system. Page 1 with the grey IMPORTANT NOTICE box should be deleted before uploading.

Note: Please read carefully the conditions set out in the Call document (for open calls: published on the Portal). Pay particular attention to the award criteria; they explain how the application will be evaluated.

PROJECT	
Project name:	Digitising European Uncontested Claims Enforcement
Project acronym:	DEUCE
Coordinator contact:	Marco Giacalone (Vrije Universiteit Brussel - VUB)

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##APP-FORM-JUST@#

##PRJ-SUM-PS@# [This document is tagged. Do not delete the tags; they are needed for the processing.]

PROJECT SUMMARY

Project summary

See Abstract (Application Form Part A).

#SPRJ-SUM-PSS# #@REL-EVA-RE@# #@PRJ-OBJ-PO@#

1. RELEVANCE

1.1 Background and general objectives

Background and general objectives

Describe the background and rationale of the project.

How is the project relevant to the scope of the call? How does the project address the general objectives of the call? What is the project's contribution to the priorities of the call?

Which target groups will be supported/assisted by/in the project. Why have you chosen to focus on them?

Background

Within the framework of the Area of Freedom, Security and Justice, many are the EU procedural instruments aimed at reducing formalities for the enforcement of judicial decisions on trans-national pecuniary claims. Starting with Brussels I (and the further Brussels I bis), the EU legislator established various Regulations to promote judicial cooperation in cross-border civil and commercial matters and to **simplify cross-border debt collection**, including the **Regulation on European Enforcement Order for uncontested claims** (EEO - Regulation No. 805/2004) and the **Regulation on European Order for Payment Procedure** (EOP - Regulation No. 1896/2006). **Unlike Brussels I/I Bis, EEO and EOP are optional for the creditor and institute European rules that operate parallel to national ones.**

The EEO Regulation introduced the most significant innovation in the field of European judicial cooperation since the adoption of the Brussels Convention in 1968. Indeed, **it abolishes the recognition and exequatur procedures in uncontested pecuniary claims within the EU area for court judgments, court settlements and authentic instruments issued in one of the Member States (MSs).** This harmonizing outcome is made possible **through the release, by an appropriate authority, of a certificate attesting the compliance of the national proceedings with the specific procedural guarantees required by the Regulation¹.**

The EOP Regulation, instead, broke new ground as it **created a uniform European procedure for cross-border disputes, targeted at determining that a monetary claim is uncontested and thus enforceable through the issuance of a court order.** As a result, **the Regulation – and not the national law of MSs – directly confers enforceability to the judgment rendered within the European proceeding².**

Compared to the Brussels system, the **added value of these two Regulations for a potential creditor is clear: they create uniform rapid procedures resulting in judicial products that can freely circulate throughout all MSs.**

However, as stated in several EU projects on these topics (among all IC2BE³ and EFFORTS⁴), the **enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgments is still governed by the national procedural rules of MSs.** The existing **inconsistencies and fragmentation in the domestic procedures** cause difficulties for creditors (as the primary beneficiaries) **but also for lawyers and bailiffs (as the operators), hindering the expedited, cost-efficient and simplified enforcement of EEO and EOP rulings⁵.**

From the arduous fulfilment of some procedural requirements to interpretation difficulties and the differentiated scope of the Regulations, three obstacles particularly stand out:

- The lack of digitalization for the enforcement process
- The lack of transparent and coherent data on enforcement rules of EEO and EOP judgments in different MSs
- The lack of awareness of EEO and EOP procedures among its primary end-users (i.e., creditors, consumers, EU entrepreneurs and legal practitioners).

The combination of these factors leads to an overall uncertainty about the applicable national rules to ensure the enforcement of EEO and EOP decisions, in most cases obscure for the creditor who obtained a favourable judgement in a cross-border claim. These practical issues, moreover, represent a disincentive for the resort of the Regulations, increasing the chances of absent or delayed enforcement. As a result,

¹ Talia Kruger, Fieke van Overbeeke, 'European Enforcement Order', in Jan von Hein and Thalia Kruger (eds.), *Informed Choices in Cross-Border Enforcement* (Intersentia 2020).

² Burkhard Hess, Pietro Ortolani (eds.), *Impediments of National Procedural Law to the Freedom of Judgments*, v. I (Nomos 2019); Bernard Ulrici, European Order for Payment Procedure, in Jan von Hein and Thalia Kruger (eds.), *Informed Choices in Cross-Border Enforcement* (Intersentia 2020).

³ <https://ic2be.uantwerpen.be/>

⁴ <https://efforts.unimi.it/>

⁵ Xandra Kramer, 'Specific Instruments', in Burkhard Hess and Pietro Ortolani (eds.), *Impediments of National Procedural Law to the Free Movement of Judgments*, (Nomos 2019); Marco Buzzoni, Cristina Mariottini, Michele Casi and Carlos Santaló Goris, *Report on EU Policy Guidelines* (2022) <https://efforts.unimi.it/wp-content/uploads/sites/8/2022/09/Report-on-EU-Policy-Guidelines_FINAL.pdf> accessed 5 April 2023.

despite the potential of the two normative initiatives in terms of simplification of transnational debt collection, their practical use is still scarce among the majority of the MSs⁶.

In light of the pressing need for efficient cross-border judicial cooperation, DEUCE Project perfectly falls within the scope of application of the Proposal for a *Regulation on the digitalisation of judicial cooperation and access to justice in cross-border civil, commercial and criminal matters* COM(2021)759 final. Indeed, **DEUCE aims to improve the enforcement of EEO and EOP judgments by reducing practical difficulties through effective, cost-efficient and simplified cooperation in the cross-border enforcement of pecuniary claims.**

In fulfilling such a challenging goal, DEUCE will rely on the successful results obtained within the previous three projects managed by the Consortium: SCAN (2018-2020, JUST-JCOO-AG-2017), EFFORTS (2020-2022, JUST-JCOO-AG-2019) and SCAN II (2018-2021, JUST-JCOO-AG-2017). In its activities, DEUCE will significantly benefit from SCAN II and EFFORTS databases (the former for ESCP Regulation and the latter for EEO and EOP guidelines), from **SCAN experience for what concerns surveys and interviews for the creation of the comprehensive Roadmap as well as from the strong and supportive network of various stakeholders** (i.e., ECC-Nets, legal practitioners, academics). From a methodological perspective, the synergic collaboration among the legal unit partners in conducting a plethora of research activities and hands-on tasks is demonstrated by the successful outputs achieved in the above-mentioned projects. Furthermore, DEUCE's objectives complement and support the eu-LISA widespread efforts to digitalise EU Justice. Currently the front-runner Agency in managing large-scale IT systems, **eu-LISA's core activity consists of interoperability, namely the efficient communication and cooperation of IT systems to provide EU law enforcement officials with quicker access to comprehensive information and to improve cross-border judicial cooperation.** Hence, by promoting the use of EEO and EOP procedures, **which offer simplified instruments for the recovery of monetary claims**, DEUCE will enable the development of a favourable environment for the large-scale adoption of the e-CODEX Project, now being incorporated into the eu-LISA framework. The envisaged result thus consists of the implementation of an interoperable, secure and decentralised communication network between national IT systems in cross-border civil and criminal proceedings.

General Objectives

In order to facilitate the enforcement of decisions on EU cross-border pecuniary claims in the short term, maximizing the efficiency of the existing normative is a priority of the DEUCE Project. To this end, **DEUCE intends to address the issue of the scarce coordination among MSs in the enforcement phase of EEO and EOP decisions.** More specifically, **DEUCE aims at facilitating cross-border enforcement procedures by relying on a fully tech-driven process, easy to use for creditors and economic operators, as well as by raising awareness of the practical functioning of the relevant enforcement rules in different MSs.**

To accomplish the objectives described, the **plan of action** elaborated by the present project consists of two main parts:

- a) **Creating a Comprehensive Roadmap** mainly for the end-users and secondly for the categories involved in the EEO and EOP enforcement procedures at national levels, to fill the existing lack of **transparency and coherence in national enforcement rules of EEO and EOP judgments** that have caused difficulties for the judgment holders to enforce it;
- b) **Simplifying and digitalizing the enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgments via the establishment of an advanced IT Platform** and developing a **Blockchain System** for handling the EEO and EOP enforcement procedures.

Therefore, **the target groups of the DEUCE Project in all 26 MSs are:**

- a. **end-users (creditors)** and **lawyers** involved in the application of EEO and EOP Regulations (at least 200 end-users and 200 lawyers to be involved);
- b. **consumer associations/European Consumer Protection Centers Network (ECC-Net)** at 26 MSs, who have immediate and direct contact with the end-users and play an essential role in raising awareness of the national enforcement procedure (in the context of EEO and EOP judgments) and their practical functioning;
- c. **bailiffs**, who are **directly involved in the enforcement process of EEO and EOP judgments** and play a key role in providing valuable information on the specific enforcement rules of their MSs (at least 200 bailiffs to be involved);
- d. **notaries**, as the issuing authorities for the enforcement of authentic instruments (at least 100 notaries to be involved);
- e. **policymakers** (at least five policymakers to be involved from the MSs of the consortium).

1.2 Needs analysis and specific objectives

Needs analysis and specific objectives

Provide a needs assessment. A need is a gap between what is and what should/ would be helpful or useful.

The needs assessment should be your starting point. Specify what needs will be addressed and how they have been identified. It should be specific and focus on the actual needs of the target group. It should include relevant, reliable data and, a robust analysis clearly demonstrating the need for the action (therefore, avoid references to generic

⁶ See, for instance, the national reports included in note 1.

statements and information about the problems and needs of the target group). The needs assessment should incorporate gender equality issues and non-discrimination considerations that identify the differences between and among women and men, girls and boys, in terms of their relative position in society and the distribution of resources, opportunities, constraints and power in a given context. The data supporting the needs assessment should be disaggregated by sex, as well as age or disability, whenever possible. You can refer to existing research, studies and previous projects that already demonstrate the need for action.

If your project is supported by a public authority, attach the letter of support in annex.

Needs Analysis

The need assessment of the DEUCE Project is developed on the basis of the identified issues regarding the EEO and EOP regulations and the lack of simplification and digitalization of this instrument across the Union. In this sense, it will be key to look at the findings of comprehensive academic studies and EU-funded projects that dealt with judicial cooperation and access to justice in cross-border civil and commercial matters, specifically on the two normative instruments. (a) First, we refer to the EU-wide evaluation study⁷ on “national procedural laws and practices in terms of their impact on the free circulation of judgments and on the equivalence and effectiveness of the procedural protection of consumers under EU consumer law”. The study identified as significant issues the right defence, the application of the service rules and rules on the translation of documents as well as the interpretation of the concept of ‘uncontested claim’ under Art. 3 EEO and the competence for the certification of the judgment. (b) Identical gaps regarding the qualification as the uncontested claim, the competence for certification and the interaction with national rules and the service rules were mapped out by the interlinked Projects: *European Union Private International Law: Legal Application in Reality* (EU PILLAR)⁸ and - *Informed Choices in Cross-Border Enforcement* (IC2BE)⁹. (c) In addition, also the conclusions of Train 2 (EN4CE)¹⁰ – Train to Enforce Project are considered since it focused on the cross-border exchange of good practices among academics and the training of legal practitioners in 7 MSs and one candidate State.

More in detail, the main issues about the EEO Regulation identified by the targets of the study were:

- a) insufficient protection to the right to review of the defendant, deriving in most cases from poor implementation of the right to apply for a review at a national level;
- b) issues about the service of documents (divergence of the service rules, rather stringent requirements for service of documents);
- c) lack of knowledge/little use;
- d) no clear relationship between the national rules of civil procedure and the EEO Regulation, in general, the difficult interconnection between the Regulation and national civil rules;
- e) issues with the interpretation of the expression “uncontested claims” used in Art.3;
- f) viewed as rather complex the situation where the defendant's domicile is not known (for the CJEU, when the defendant's domicile is unknown, the Regulation doesn't apply - Case C-292/10, *G v Cornelius de Visser* [2012], ECLI:EU:C:2012:142). From this point of view, the scarce cooperation between national agencies and services and the lack of electronic information on the domicile causes hardships.

The core problems identified with the EOP Regulation were instead:

- a) lack of clear rules on the cross-border service of documents;
- b) the absence of implementing legislation in several Member States, complicating the already difficult interaction with national law;
- c) little use/lack of knowledge;
- d) competence issues;
- e) a widespread misconception about the conditions for an EOP application;
- f) issues with the use of the forms.

For the reasons above, DEUCE Consortium firmly believe that the enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgements still remains one of the major weaknesses of this Procedure. The inharmonious practices of executing EEO and EOP judgments and the lack of simplification and digitalisation make it difficult for end-users to enforce the obtained judgment in an effective, simplified, expedited, and cost-efficient manner.

By building on the successful findings of SCAN, EFFORTS and SCAN II Projects, DEUCE will benefit from the solid experience acquired by the Consortium partners in conducting in-depth research, webinars, final conferences as well practice-oriented deliverables. Notably, DEUCE Project will deliver on the basis of SCAN II results about the European Small Claims Procedure, a similar comprehensive Roadmap but this time focused on the EEO and EOP enforcement rules of the 26 MSs. Concurrently, the limited number of enforced EEO and EOP judgments demonstrates the compelling need for simplifying and digitalising the EEO and EOP enforcement rules. Therefore, the DEUCE Project will develop an advanced IT Platform, establishing a transparent and secure Blockchain System to implement a fully tech-driven mechanism to

⁷ See ‘An evaluation study of national procedural laws and practices in terms of their impact on the free circulation of judgments and on the equivalence and effectiveness of the procedural protection of consumers under EU consumer law. Report prepared by a Consortium of European universities led by the MPI Luxembourg for Procedural Law as commissioned by the European Commission, JUST/2014/RCON/PR/CIVI/0082’ (2017).

⁸ <https://w3.abdn.ac.uk/clsm/eupillar/>

⁹ <https://ic2be.uantwerpen.be/>

¹⁰ <https://www.pf.um.si/en/acj/projects/pr10-train2en4ce/>

fill the current gaps in the EEO and EOP enforcement across the Union.

Specific Objectives

In line with the needs and targets mentioned above, the project will pursue the following main objectives:

1. **Create a Roadmap for the enforcement rules of all 26 MSs (except Denmark) on enforcing the EEO and EOP judgments.** This goal will be achieved through a) collecting data from the 26 MSs about their applicable procedural rules concerning the enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgments. The legal unit will conduct this activity (VUB: BE, NL, LU; UniZg: HR, HU, BG; UL: SLO, CZ, SK; Taltech: EE, SE, FI, VU: LT, MT, LV; UBA: ES, PT, EL; UNINA: IT, CY, IE) and Adiconsum: RO, EUBF: F and ZEV: AT, DE FBE: PL of the DEUCE Consortium consulting the related procedural laws of each jurisdiction, b) analyzing the data gathered and assessing their accuracy, preciseness, and relevance to the EEO and EOP enforcement (by reaching out to 1 lawyer and one bailiff per targeted MS), resulting in the **Roadmap of the relevant enforcement procedural rules** (which will be circulated among min. 1500 end-users via the 26 national consumer associations/European Consumer Centers Network (ECC-Net); further, it will be made available to min. 200 lawyers via FBE, 200 bailiffs via EUBF, 200 notaries via the consortium and the supporting entities during the project).
2. **Simplify and digitalise the enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgments by developing an advanced IT Platform.** This tool will contain all the analyzed data of the previous objective, against the backdrop of the identified needs, to provide support and guidance for end-users and lawyers on the EEO and EOP enforcement rules in every MS, using a user-friendly IT platform.
3. **Develop a blockchain system to promote the effective enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgments across the MSs.** This system will also thoroughly evaluate the behavioural issues of the users in the context of accountability and governance issues via conducting survey data, interviews, and a focus group during the project.
4. **Raise awareness of the end-users and the operators about the enforcement rules of EEO and EOP judgments in different MSs by** (i) circulating the outcomes of the Project via the Project Website and dedicated social media accounts (LinkedIn, Twitter and Facebook), capable of reaching out, respectively, 2500 visitors for the Website, and 200 followers per profile, (ii) progressively building the "DEUCE Network" (involving 100 lawyers, 100 bailiffs, and 26 consumer associations throughout EU), (iii) disseminating the outcomes of the Project in a Final Conference involving at least 120 attendees from the operators and the end-users (and even more audience via the video uploaded onto the Project Website, the social media accounts, and other public platforms (i.e., YouTube) after the Conference).

#@COM-PLE-CP@#

1.3 Complementarity with other actions and innovation — European added value

Complementarity with other actions and innovation

Explain how the project builds on the results of past activities carried out in the field and describe its innovative aspects. Explain how the activities are complementary to other activities carried out by other organisations.

Illustrate the European dimension of the activities: trans-national dimension of the project; impact/interest for a number of EU countries; possibility to use the results in other countries, potential to develop mutual trust/cross-border cooperation among EU countries, etc.

Which countries will benefit from the project (directly and indirectly and why have you chosen them)? Where will the activities take place?

Clarify to what extent the project builds on synergies with other EU projects. If applicable, explain to what extent your project builds on previous project results in this field (state of play, relation to existing/recent developments, approaches, achievements, other EU programmes).

Note: The project should also complement or add benefits to the EU Member States' interventions in the area of gender equality and non-discrimination mainstreaming.

The European Added value

The DEUCE Project aims at **ensuring the correct, consistent, and simplified enforcement of the EEO and EOP Regulations, contributing to the free circulation of judgments across the EU and enhancing effective cooperation in this sense.** The Project will foster uniformity of national enforcement rules in the context of the DEUCE EEO and EOP Regulations within 26 EU MSs and increase legal certainty. It entails a high European added value as it promotes citizens' access to justice by enabling them to assert their rights in the Union. Accordingly, the DEUCE Project:

- a) fosters **legal certainty** by clearly addressing coherent and homogeneous enforcement of the EEO and EOP Regulations in interaction with the national enforcement rules, and particularly **promoting the simplified enforcement of these Regulations at a national level**;
- b) sets up national and international forums for encouraging and supporting dialogue on how to address practical difficulties associated with cross-border enforcement of civil judicial decisions, particularly monetary claims. Such discussions greatly involve legal professionals – incl. practitioners, judiciary staff, and academics – from the entire Union **to establish and sustain active collaborations** with their foreign colleagues in addressing the specific issues in cross-border enforcement of civil judicial decisions;
- c) contributes to the **establishment and strengthening of a European network**, which is relevant to **facilitate cooperation** between legal professionals at an international and regional level;

d) facilitates **mutual learning, exchange of best practices, and development of enforcement methods at national levels**;

e) **reduces barriers to access to justice for citizens in cross-border enforcement of civil judgments** through **raising awareness** of the enforcement rules for end users and legal practitioners;

f) **simplifies the access to justice for the end users** by provision of transparent and coherent information for enforcement of cross-border civil judgments, particularly in pecuniary claims.

The Project materials will be freely available on the Project Website and its social media accounts. In particular, the national consumer protection centres will make available, on their websites, the Comprehensive Roadmap for end users. For legal practitioners, this document will be shared by the **FBE** and the **EUBF** (via a mailing list to their subscribed members). The Project will target the entire MSs (except Denmark) and will have an immediate impact on all the potential end users and the legal practitioners of the EEO and EOP with the aim to promote the cross-border enforcement of judicial decisions in the DEUCE Regulations for anyone from any MS. To ensure that every potential stakeholder of the EEO and EOP will have access to the Comprehensive Roadmap, this instrument will be freely accessible in all the EU official languages on the DEUCE Website. The Guidelines and the Comparative and Analytical Study will be accessible in English.

DEUCE will **build upon synergies** with the prior SCAN, SCAN II, and EFFORTS Projects, benefitting from the existing databases (specifically, the SCAN and SCAN II database for ESCP Regulation) and the established strong and supporting network (i.e., ECC-Nets, legal practitioners, academics) and from the general identification of the issues and difficulties caused by ineffective enforcement of the EEO and EOP Regulations within the Union, while expanding its territorial scope to other EU MSs. From a methodological perspective, DEUCE will benefit from the solid experience acquired by the majority of Consortium partners in conducting webinars, final conferences, and deliverables strongly based on practice. DEUCE will particularly benefit from the experience and databases of SCAN II (as regards the Roadmap and the Comparative and Analytical Study) and SCAN (concerning surveys and interviews as well as Guidelines for EU and national policymakers). Concurrently, the principal issues for gender mainstreaming and respect for fundamental rights in the DEUCE Project include: 1) ensuring the equal inclusion and participation in the scoping process (in all the project stages); 2) developing accessible materials that do not exhibit gender bias (primarily in WPs 2,3, and 4); 3) guarantying equal inclusion and participation in the dissemination process (WP5). Responding to the gender bias is primarily attained through addressing the recruitment and participation issues, as well as by critical review of the developed materials at both internal and public levels. Where applicable, DEUCE will incorporate gender and equality issues in the project.

#SCOM-PLC-CP# #SPRJ-OBJ-POS# #SREL-EVA-RES# #@QUA-LIT-QL@# #@CON-MET-CM@#

2. QUALITY

2.1 Concept and methodology

Concept and methodology

Outline the approach and methodology behind the project. Explain why they are the most suitable for achieving the project's objectives. Include ethical and safety considerations to ensure that target groups are not subjected to harm in any way.

Note: Methodology is not a list of activities but are instruments, approaches that will be used, applied and created.

The DEUCE embraces a practice-driven methodology (already successful in the implementation of the SCAN2 projects towards the European small claims procedure and the DEUCE consortium firmly believe that such a methodology could be relevant and successful also in DEUCE project towards EEO and EOP procedures) based on the following major pillars:

- having a constant **dialogue** with end-users (mainly via consumer associations) and the legal practitioners (via the stakeholders involved directly and indirectly in the consortium through webinars, national and international meetings, and the international final conference) with the aim of detecting difficulties and issues arisen in enforcement of EEO and EOP judgments in various MSs. This interaction will take place in the form of surveys, focus groups and interviews to collect data and through the roundtable workshop with the twofold aim of disseminating results, but also challenging them towards their actual usefulness and relevance in the field.
- exchanging and **sharing good practices** at national and international levels to support the creation of a common mindset among the operators involved in the enforcement of EEO and EOP judgments, as well as conducting **analytical activities** to create a standard structure to ensure outcomes are concretely comparable and meet the specific objectives of the project. The final goal is, however, to compose a comprehensive Roadmap of the 26 MSs that fits well the needs of players in the EEO and EOP enforcement procedures at national levels;
- **testing the IT platform** (with consumers/creditors as end-users and lawyers/bailiffs as the operators) and **the developed blockchain system** (with operators involved in the enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgments) through two experimental phases. Interviews, surveys and focus groups will be used with the stakeholders as the appropriate methods for the project, as discussed in WP4 in detail.

The monitoring and evaluation of the achieved outcomes of the Project will be carried out by a Committee composed of five external professional evaluators (CEPE), in close interaction with the Project's Academic

Advisory Board (AAB). This phase will give further incentives to promote the performance of the tasks and activities carried out by the Project partners.

The proposed bottom-up approach is entirely appropriate for the purposes of the DEUCE Project, since it leads to propose concrete solutions and tools that are practically feasible in meeting the needs of end-users of the EEO and EOP, also to tackle the difficulties in sharing best practices of EEO and EOP judgments enforcement at the Union level.

Such a firmly scientific standpoint is grounded in the analytical activities conducted by the academic members of the Project Consortium.

#\$CON-MET-CMS# #@CON-SOR-CS@#

2.2 Consortium set-up

Consortium cooperation and division of roles (if applicable)

Describe the participants (Beneficiaries, Affiliated Entities and Associated Partners, if any) and explain how they will work together to implement the project. How will they bring together the necessary expertise? How will they complement each other?

In what way does each of the participants contribute to the project? Show that each has a valid role and adequate resources to fulfil that role.

Note: When building your consortium you should think of organisations that can help you reach objectives and solve problems.

DEUCE Project can count on strong alliance among universities (**VUB**, **VU**, **TalTech**, **UL**, **UniZg**, **UNINA**, **UB**), consumer associations (**Adiconsum**, **ZEVI**), the Federation of European Bars Associations (**FBE**), and the European Bailiffs' Foundation (**EUBF**) that have often joined their forces in miscellaneous EU research projects and publications that manifest their outstanding and proven track record in international procedural laws and international private law. Since each beneficiary is highly competent in civil procedural laws, international private law, consumer protection policies, and management studies, each of them will perform the tasks according to their expertise.

As regards the creation of the Roadmap of the 26 EU MSs, **VUB** for BE, NL, FR; **UniZg** for HR, HU; **VU** for LT, LV, BG; **UNINA** for IT, CY; IE; **ZEVI** for DE, AT; **UB** for EL, ES; **TalTech** for EE, FI, SE; **UL** for SI, CZ, SK; **EUBF** for LU; **Adiconsum** for RO, PT; and **FBE** for PL, MT will carry out activities related to data collection and data analysis of enforcement rules of EEO and EOP decisions in MSs. These efforts will be conducted for the purpose of filling the existing gaps in inharmonious enforcement rules, lack of awareness among the EEO and EOP end users and overcoming uncertainties about such rules among the legal practitioners.

Concerning the cross-border exchange of practices, the comparative analysis conducted for the Roadmap, the establishment of the IT Platform and the Blockchain system as a means to facilitate supranational and inter-professional dialogues (i.e. the collaboration between the legal unit and IT specialists, also creation of the 'DEUCE Network'), and organizing national Webinars will ensure circulation of experiences and views, mutual learnings, and a high capacity-building for cooperation in harmonizing EEO and EOP enforcement rules.

As regards the contribution to the Project, **VUB** will undertake the **managerial aspects** of the Project as well as ensures the effective implementation of the overall protection strategy in meeting the objectives of **WP1**. **VU** will ensure the coherence and compatibility of **WP2** outcomes with a view to concretely achieve the objective of **creating the Roadmap for EU enforcement rules** as regards EEO and EOP judgments. **UNINA** will contribute with its outstanding experience in **simplifying and digitalizing public services** through developing software modules that perform the simplification of uncontested monetary claim enforcement procedures in order to support the end-users and the operators towards the accomplishment of objectives in **WP3**. **TalTech**, with its solid competence in legal tech, will ensure **WP4** and will accordingly tailor its objectives in developing the IT Platform and in establishing the **Blockchain System**. This will be supported by surveys, interviews and focus groups in all the participating countries. Ultimately, **VUB**, with its proven track record in managing dissemination activities (i.e., scientific publications and organizing international conferences, seminars, and workshops) will be the driving force for the dissemination of the Project outputs (**WP5**).

Since DEUCE highly values a practice-driven approach, there is a remarkable emphasis on close and persistent collaboration with representatives of consumer associations in Europe, lawyers, bailiffs, and other enforcing agents involved in executing EEO and EOP judgments; therefore, the Project has received the **support letters** from: the Ministry of Justice of the Republic of Estonia, Chambre nationale des commissaires de justice de France "CNCJ" (French National Chamber of Bailiffs), National Association of Consumer Protection (InfoCons) in Romania, the Lithuanian Consumer Institute, Centre for education and informing consumers in Croatia, as well as the Associazione Italiana fra gli studiosi del processo civile, in Italy (cf Annex). Their support to DEUCE project will be invaluable as they will provide constructive feedback on the final outputs, in accordance with their

expertise. A '**Committee of External Professional Evaluators**', appointed at the start of the Project will closely collaborate with partners to ensure effective implementation of the Project. Specifically, **EUBF, FBE, Adiconsum and ZEV** support entities – through their extensive networks – assist the partners for collecting national data on the EEO and EOP enforcement rules in MSs, also for disseminating the Project results, acting as a multiplier factor in efficiently accomplishing awareness raising objective of DEUCE.

2.3 Project teams, staff and experts

Project teams and staff

Describe the project teams and how they will work together to implement the project.

List the staff included in the project budget (budget category A) by function/profile (e.g. project manager, senior expert/advisor/researcher, junior expert/advisor/researcher, trainers/teachers, technical personnel, administrative personnel etc. — use the same profiles as in the detailed budget table, if any (n/a for prefixed Lump Sum Grants)) and describe briefly their tasks. Provide CVs of all key actors.

Note: Please ensure a gender-balanced representation in the composition of project teams and staff performing the action.

Name and function	Organisation	Role/tasks/professional profile and expertise
Dr. Marco Giacalone (Project Coordinator/Manager)	VUB	[Male] Project Coordinator. Marco is currently the Project Coordinator of two DG JUST projects SCAN2 and CREA2. Dr. Giacalone is the Digitalisation and Access to Justice (DIKE) Research group Co-Director at VUB. His focus is on Private International Law, Access to Justice and Law & Technology.
Prof. Dr. Kim Van Der Borgh (Project Deputy Coordinator/Manager)	VUB	[Male] As a deputy-COO, coordinating the project along with dr Giacalone (with the help of the Sr & Jr researchers) Prof. Van Der Borgh has great expertise in international economic law, monetary law, and civil dispute resolution, and teaches at International Economic Law at the Centre for Economic Law & Governance (Vrije Universiteit Brussel), as a Reader in Law at Westminster University and as an Adjunct Professor of Law at Georgia University (USA).
Prof. Gina Gioia (Senior Researcher)	VUB	[Female] Prof. Gioia will help the COO and the deputy-COO to perform their tasks and she has participated in SCAN/She is a senior lecturer in international civil procedural law at Tuscia University in Viterbo, Italy.
Sajedeh Salehi (Junior Researcher)	VUB	[Female] Salehi will help the COO and the deputy-COO to perform their tasks and she will take care of communicating the coordination information to the partners. She participated in SCAN/SCAN II, Salehi conducts research in civil procedural law, ODR, consumer law, and small claims dispute resolution.
Francesca Valastro (Junior Researcher)	VUB	[Female] Valastro will contribute to the COO and deputy-COO tasks and she will take care of communicating the coordination information to the partners. She conducts research in civil procedural law, ADR, ODR and AI applications.
Prof. Dr. Tatjana Josipovic (Team Leader)	UniZg	[Female] Leadership of the UniZg team in working on the WP2 and WP5/She has great expertise in civil law, European private and business law.
Dr. Ivana Kanceljak (Senior Researcher)	UniZg	[Female] Helping Prof. Josipovic in her work for DEUCE/She has expertise in civil law and EU private law.
Prof. Flora Amato (Team Leader)	UNINA	[Female] Responsible for coordinating WP3 and leading her team members. She participated in several project with the consortium.
Prof. Dr. Giovanni Zarra (Team Leader)	UNINA	[Male] Leadership of the UNINA Legal Unit. He has great academic and professional expertise in private international law and international litigation.

Dr. Loris Marotti (Senior Researcher)	UNINA	[Male] Helping Prof. Zarra in his work. He has expertise in national and EU private law and investment law.
Paola Giacalone (Junior Researcher)	UNINA	[Female] Helping Prof. Zarra in his work. She has expertise in international civil and commercial dispute resolution.
Assoc. Prof. Dr. Rimantas Simaitis (Team Leader)	VU	[Male] Leadership of the VU team in working on the WP2 and WP5. He participated in SCAN/He has great academic and professional expertise in international civil procedure law, ODR, and enforcement of e-justice.
Assoc. Prof. Vėbraitė Vigita (Senior Researcher)	VU	[Female] Helping Prof. Simaitis in his work for DEUCE/She has extensive expertise in national and EU civil procedural law, ADR, and ODR.
Milda Markevičiūtė (Junior Researcher)	VU	[Female] Helping Prof. Simaitis in his work for DEUCE. She participated in SCAN/She has expertise in civil law, ADR, and ODR.
Prof. Dr. Katarina Zajc (Team Leader)	UL	[Female] Leadership of the UL team in working on the WP2 and WP5. She participated in SCAN/She has great expertise in law and economics.
Dr. Ana Oblack	UL	[Female] Helping Prof. Zajc in her work for DEUCE/ She has expertise in law and economics.
Maksimilijan Gale (Junior Researcher)	UL	[Male] Helping Prof. Zajc in her work for DEUCE. He participated in SCAN. He has expertise is civil law, economics, and law.
Prof. Thomas Hoffmann (Team Leader)	TalTech	[Male] Leadership of the Taltech team in working on the WP2 and WP5. He participated in SCAN2. He has great expertise in law and technology.
Prof. Tanel Kerikmäe (Senior Researcher)	TalTech	[Male] Helps Prof. Hoffmann in his work for DEUCE. He participated in several projects with this consortium
Dr. Maria Claudia Solarte	TalTech	[Female] Helping Prof. Hoffmann in his work for DEUCE. She has expertise law and technology.
Paola Pendenza (Team Leader)	Adiconsum	[Female] Pendenza leads Adiconsum team and is responsible for the Webinar and the press release. She participated in SCAN/She has extensive experience in with the field of consumer protection.
Flaminia Santilli (Senior Expert)	Adiconsum	[Female] Helps Paola Pendenza for the Webinar and the press release/She is expert in the field of consumer law and consumer protection.
Izabela Konopacka (Senior Expert)	FBE	[Female] Konopacka participates in WP2 and WP5 regarding FBE-related tasks/She is the 2 nd Vice President of the FBE and an experienced lawyer in dealing with cross-border civil and commercial disputes.
Maria Dymitruk (Senior Expert)	FBE	[Female] Helping Konopacka in her work. She has expertise in private international law and application of new technologies in the field of law and legal practice.
Luc Ferrand (Team Leader)	EUBF	[Male] Ferrand is EUBF Team Leader and participates in WP2 and WP5/ He is a senior advisor to the European Bailiff Foundation and has expertise in private law, directing projects and providing legal advice.
Magdalena Jankowska-Gilberg (Team Leader)	ZEV	[Female] Magdalena Jankowska-Gilberg is ZEV Team Leader and participates in WP2 and WP5. She is a legal advisor specialized in civil law.

Outside resources (subcontracting, seconded staff, etc)

If you do not have all skills/resources in-house, describe how you intend to get them (contributions of members, partner organisations, subcontracting, etc).

If there is subcontracting, please also complete the table in section 4. Moreover, ensure that subcontractors are aware of gender mainstreaming and non-discrimination mainstreaming.

n/a

2.4 Consortium management and decision-making**Consortium management and decision-making (if applicable)**

Explain the management structures and decision-making mechanisms within the consortium. Describe how decisions will be taken and how regular and effective communication will be ensured. Describe methods to ensure planning and control.

Note: *The concept (including organisational structure and decision-making mechanisms) must be adapted to the complexity and scale of the project.*

For an effective project management, DEUCE is built upon the following fundamental principles: a) clearly defined tasks assigned to BENs in accordance to their expertise, competences, and prior experiences; b) already-tested practical tools to guide the Project implementation; c) a close and constant monitoring of the Project implementation by the Coordinator, the Committee of External Professional Evaluators, the Academic Advisory Board and the Ethics Committee of the Project.

The project management and decision-making are mainly based upon the central role of a Steering Committee (SC), co-chaired by Dr. Marco Giacalone (COO) and Prof. Kim Van Der Borgh (Deputy-COO), and one team leaders from each BEN. Since, the members of the SC have already closely collaborated in several EU research projects and activities at national and cross-border levels across EU, this Committee will thence be able to react to any situation and propose solutions to any probable contrasts or difficulties within the Consortium. The SC will also benefit from support of the representatives of the entities who expressed their incentives (through the support letters) to assist the Consortium to deal with any difficulty that may arise during the national data collection or/and analytical activities, also the dissemination phase to ensure the output will concretely respond to the needs of the end-users and the operators. The monitoring and evaluation organs will assist the coordinator in meeting targets and deadlines of each task. The coordination among partners will be ensured by holding frequent Skype and/or MS Teams coordination meetings, creating mailing lists for the WPs with specific tasks, e-mails and messages. In addition, to sustain a harmonized and consistent framework, there will be a uniform template for each deliverable, and the project meetings, webinars and the final conference will have written instructions to be communicated in advance. The VUB as the Coordinator will create an official e-mail for the project (deuce-project@vub.be) to facilitate communications for the BENs' financial officers, in addition to an ad hoc mailing list that will be solely dedicated to ensuring smooth communications among these officers.

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2.5 Project management, quality assurance and monitoring and evaluation strategy**Project management, quality assurance and monitoring and evaluation strategy**

Describe the measures planned to ensure that the project implementation is of high quality and completed in time.

Describe the methods to ensure good quality, monitoring, planning and control.

Describe the evaluation methods and indicators (quantitative and qualitative) to monitor and verify the outreach and coverage of the activities and results (including unit of measurement, baseline and target values). The indicators proposed to measure progress should be relevant, realistic and measurable.

Note: *The monitoring and evaluation strategy should also incorporate gender and non-discrimination considerations in order to measure changes and assess impact on gender equality issues. The indicators should be gender responsive so that they can measure gender equality changes over time. For instance, a gender responsive indicator can measure the increase in women's rate of employment or changes in social attitudes towards gender roles in work-life balance. The evaluation should be participatory and inclusive to all stakeholders, ensuring that women's and men's voices are prevalent throughout the entire evaluation process.*

Project management

The Consortium has already established a solid network with EU universities, research institutions, consumer associations, legal practitioners foundations, and legal tech companies with high expertise in the field of law and AI, which is a proven evidence on the strong academic track, well-deserved reputation, and reliability from successful previous projects (cf Annex 4) and communications with the related communities active in the field. Additionally, the partners also hold extensive experience in data collection,

analysis, and production of the roadmap and comparative analytical study for different stakeholders in the EU. All partners will participate in periodic coordination meetings to ensure the planned progress of the project activities and discuss the major research results.

Monitoring and Evaluation

The regular coordination meetings and Online communications will ensure the continuous monitoring of the Project's progressive implementation and the efficient use of resources and expenses during the entire two-year period. To frequently keep the EU informed of the ongoing and conducted Project tasks and activities, the Consortium will submit periodical reports to the EU Portal, invite the EU officers to the events, as well as requesting advice or assistance to deal with any raised difficulty.

The implementation of the Project's activities will be evaluated on a dual-track basis:

1. A **Committee of External Professional Evaluators (CEPE)** consisting of five members that are especially selected by Consortium – from among jurists (three) and IT specialists (two) who are distinguished in the areas of legal-tech – for this evaluation purpose and they will cover the Roadmap, Comparative and Analytical Study of Best Practices, Webinars, also the Final Conference. All these outcomes will be evaluated in compliance with the criteria of the EC DAC (relevance, coherence, effectiveness, efficiency, impact and sustainability) also considering the EU visibility and the EU added value. The CEPE members will participate in at least three national webinars and the Final Conference. The CEPE will carry out the evaluation based on the information delivered by the BENs in the form of summaries and the reports of the conducted activities. The CEPE will provide the mid-term (this will lead to immediate improvement of the Project by the partners) and final evaluations of the Project's conducted activities and results in conformity with the Call priorities and the general objectives to be achieved. In case of disagreement among the EAB members, a formal vote will be conducted to determine the prevailing opinion of the majority of the members.
2. An **Academic Advisory Board (AAB)** (co-chaired by Prof. Josipovic and Prof. Zajc, plus three external members) will constantly monitor the Project's progress and the quality of the activities. The AAB will closely evaluate all the deliverables to ensure they comply with the standards of the Call also the EC DAC criteria. The Board provides specific reports for each evaluation. To guarantee the Project meets its principle objectives, also to perform the necessary corrective actions where appropriate, the AAB carefully and timely considers the following indicators in its assessments: 1. the statistical data regarding the number of visits to the project website, IT Platform, and the registrations with the blockchain system; 2. number of downloads of the Project deliverables available on the project website; 3. number of subscribers to the Project social media accounts and their metrics (to assess the amount of interactions); 4. feedback received from the visitors/users of the project website, IT Platform, and the blockchain system on their user-friendliness, simplified mechanism and the design; 5. satisfaction surveys circulated among the participants in webinars and final conference evaluating their level of awareness pre- and post-events on the topics presented to them, on the contents and the overall organization of the event, the presenters' performance also the balance and diversity of the panels in terms of expertise and professional background of the speakers; and 6. the effectiveness of the events as to the anticipated objectives
3. Project **Ethics Committee (EC)** will be in charge of ensuring compliance of all activities with the ethics requirements set out by the European Commission. As such, the EC will continuously collect the necessary information and monitor the project work. If deviations are identified from the defined principles, feedback will be given to the relevant partners for mandatory adjustments. Also, the EC will ensure that GDPR guidelines are implemented. It will define the processes and provide templates for internal project ethical applications forms and informed consent forms in the cases that humans will be involved. Gender and equity issues will be monitored to guarantee equal (to the maximum extent) representations of genders, age groups, disability, and socio-economic backgrounds. The DEUCE consortium will specifically consider the gender mainstreaming rules (in accordance with Art. 119 of Treaty of Rome 1957; Art. 2&3 of Amsterdam Treaty 1997; Art. 2&3 (TEU); Art. 8&10 (TFEU) Lisbon Treaty 2009; and UN Beijing Conference on Women 1995) to ensure the project is gender responsive (e.g., through using gender neutral language, inclusion of women in conducting managerial tasks, etc). This strategy will enable the consortium to mitigate the risks of any gender inequalities and encourage full participation of women in the entire implementation of the project. The EC will consist of all WP leaders and will be chaired by Prof. Niels Van Dijk (VUB).

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2.6 Cost effectiveness and financial management

Cost effectiveness and financial management (n/a for prefixed Lump Sum Grants)

Describe the measures adopted to ensure that the proposed results and objectives will be achieved in the most cost-effective way.

Indicate the arrangements adopted for the financial management of the project and, in particular, how the financial resources will be allocated and managed within the consortium.

 Do NOT compare and justify the costs of each work package, but summarize briefly why your budget is cost effective.

The budget has been calculated considering the following principles:

- a) the economic treatment of staff will comply with the ordinary financial treatment of University staff and other partners;
- b) the service providers will be selected following a call for tender and on the basis of 'best value for money', consistent with the EU and national rules on public procurements;
- c) the Online mode is preferred for meetings, discussions, and exchanges via using free tools (i.e., Skype, MS Teams);
- d) for physical events, the guests will reside in structures with preferential rates; and
- e) the travel tickets will be booked in advance.

The Consortium, due to the partners involvement in several e-Justice EU projects, is widely experienced in dealing with Projects and has considerable expertise in multi-tasking. Each research activity will form the foundation for the subsequent and connected Project outputs. The data collection tasks will prefer resources already present in the territory. A PhD researcher as an assistant project-manager (recruited on a part-time basis to contain costs, while ensuring continuous support) will assist the coordinator in the organizational tasks, as well as BENs' administrative staff in maintaining clear audible financial accounts.

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2.7 Risk management

Critical risks and risk management strategy

Describe critical risks, uncertainties or difficulties related to the implementation of your project, and your measures/strategy for addressing them.

Indicate for each risk (in the description) the impact and the likelihood that the risk will materialise (high, medium, low), even after taking into account the mitigating measures.

Note: Uncertainties and unexpected events occur in all organisations, even if very well-run. The risk analysis will help you to predict issues that could delay or hinder project activities. A good risk management strategy is essential for good project management. The strategy should also incorporate risk mitigation measures that redress any gender inequalities and multiple discriminatory effects in project implementation. For instance, to ensure full participation of target groups in project activities, gender, age or disability-specific constraints should be taken into account. The target groups may face more than one barrier to access project activities (accessibility barriers; language barriers, availability of childcare provision, etc.). Therefore, it is essential to identify these risks and undertake preventive measures in order to ensure full participation of women and men in all their diversity in project design and implementation.

Risk No	Description	Work package No	Proposed risk-mitigation measures
1	Long absence of the coordinator (Probability: Low, Impact: Medium);	1,2,3,4,5	The Deputy-coordinator (Prof. Van Der Borgh) will take over the role of the Coordinator (VUB).
2	Long absence of a WP's leader (Probability: Low, Impact: Medium);	1,2,3,4,5	Discussion by the SC and the role/task will be taken over by another partner along with the VUB (Coordinator) during the period of absence or until the WP lead organisation appoints another leader.
3	Difficulties to access relevant information on any kind of data in collecting national data from some MSs (Probability: Low, Impact: Medium).	2	Discussion by the SC and the role/task will be taken over by another partner in collaboration with the VUB (coordinator)
4	Difficulties in engaging the stakeholders (end-users, consumer associations/lawyers/bailiffs)	2,3,4,5	The stakeholders' representative will be invited to the webinars. The supporting entities are willing to actively assist the Consortium in

	(Probability: Low, Impact: Medium);		encouraging the potential stakeholders to get involved in the Project (cf Annex 6 for the attached support letters).
5	Delay in pilots' implementation (Probability: Medium, Impact: High);	3,4	1) Strong experience of project partners gained in similar initiatives; 2) Solid expertise in user engagement; 3) Participatory approach to ensure user-centered and accessible tools; 4) Direct connections with professionals; 5) Adequate support will be offered to users; 6) Pilots planning will identify early triggers of delays and strategies to prevent them.
6	Personal data breaches and other ethical problems raised by research (Probability: Medium, Impact: High).	1,2,3,4,5	1) Appointment of an external Ethics Committee; 2) Precaution for data management will be adopted; 3) Special attention will be paid to sensitive data
7	Technical issues in development and/or testing phase of the IT Platform/Blockchain System (Probability: Low, Impact: High);	3,4	Discussion between WP leaders and the SC to ask expertise of a third-party on board resolving the technical issue
8	Issues regarding dissemination, communication or exploitation (Probability: Low, Impact: Medium);	5	The task will be re-distributed among the partners, will find solutions through outsourcing or adopt the dissemination, communication and exploitation plan according to the situation at that moment, considering the predefined deliverables that are achieved.
9	Delay in critical deliverables (Probability: Low, Impact: Medium);	1,2,3,4,5	This risk is reduced by the expertise of the partners (both in terms of technical and management experience) that will allow the identification of planning drifts.
10	Under-performing partner/a key partner leaves the project; disagreement between partners (Probability: Medium, Impact: Medium).	1,2,3,4,5	WP leaders monitor progress at WP level and communicate difficulties to the Coordinator. Redistribution of tasks and/or seeking a new partner/researcher

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3. IMPACT

3.1 Impact and ambition

Impact and ambition

Define the short, medium and long-term effects of the project.

Who are the target groups? How will the target groups benefit concretely from the project and what would change for them? In what way will the gap identified be reduced? How will the activities contribute to improve the situation (difference between starting point/state of play and the situation after the end of the project?) How will the activities contribute to the promotion and advancement of gender equality and non-discrimination mainstreaming?

Does the project aim to trigger change/innovation? If so, describe them and the degree of ambition (progress beyond the status quo).

Note: Results/outcomes are immediate changes that materialise for the target groups after the end of the project (e.g. improved knowledge, increased awareness). Results/outcomes are different to deliverables. Deliverables are activities

undertaken and outputs produced with the resources allocated to the project, e.g. training courses, conferences, manuals, video etc.

When defining expected results/outcomes and deliverables please consider if and how they will reduce, maintain, or increase inequalities between women and men, boys and girls, in all their diversity. What gender, age and disability differentiated results can be expected? How expected results will affect women and men, boys and girls from a range of diverse social groups, differently?

Impact

The DEUCE Project will bring added value to each of the target groups by raising their awareness of the EEO and EOP enforcement rules of MSs, as well as simplifying and digitalizing this enforcement process. On this account:

1. creditors as the end-users will be encouraged to use the EEO and EOP as the enforcement process (that is currently a major hurdle for executing the obtained EEO and EOP judgment) will be remarkably facilitated by an advanced IT Platform and a Blockchain System at their disposal, free of charge and developed in the users European language, which will offer simple information on the Procedure and which will be able to guide them in using the procedure through the e-Justice Portal. The IT Platform and the Blockchain System that will be developed has many advantages: i. It's not territorially bound; ii. It's the easiest, most immediate, and reliable (due to conducted accountability test during the Project) means to consult; iii. It's continuously updated and expandable.
2. lawyers and bailiffs as the operators will have a facilitated access to the IT Platform and the Blockchain System to be used in enforcement process;
3. national and European legislators will be able to have at their disposal updated data, concrete studies and research, and suggestions from which they can start to evaluate any appropriate legislative changes aimed at a greater harmonization of the civil procedural systems. The most evident immediate change that materialises for the target groups will be the simplified access to the EEO and EOP, in the new procedural forms promoted by the European Union.

Concurrently, the principle issues for gender mainstreaming and respect for fundamental rights in the DEUCE project include: (1) ensuring the equal inclusion and participation in the scoping process (in all the project stages), (2) developing accessible materials that do not exhibit gender bias (primarily in WP3 and 5), (3) guarantying equal inclusion and participation in the dissemination process (WP5). responding to the gender bias is primarily attained through addressing the recruitment and participation issues, as well as by critical review of the developed materials at both internal and public levels. Where applicable, DEUCE will incorporate gender and equality issues in the project.

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3.2 Communication, dissemination and visibility

Communication, dissemination and visibility of funding

Describe the communication and dissemination activities which are planned in order to promote the activities/results and maximise the impact (to whom, which format, how many, etc.). Clarify how you will reach the target groups, relevant stakeholders, policymakers and the general public and explain the choice of the dissemination channels.

Describe how the visibility of EU funding will be ensured.

Communication and dissemination activities should also contribute to the promotion of gender equality and non-discrimination. Communication materials should use gender inclusive language and positive visual representations. E.g.: When developing videos or leaflets ensure that women and men, in all their diversity, are equally represented in a non-stereotypical fashion and portrayed in active empowered roles. In addition, consider using communication channels that they are accessible to general audience, in particular to persons with disabilities, or people from marginalised groups.

The DEUCE Consortium aims at giving widespread visibility to the Project and the achieved results at the outset of the Project by: i) drafting leaflets entailing the details of the Project, its objectives and scope with the precise agenda for the Project activities and deliverables. These leaflets will be circulated in hard/soft copies in any events/opportunities where the potential stakeholders (esp. creditors, lawyers, bailiffs, consumers associations) are present, as well as among all the supporting entities to circulate among their members; ii) establishing the Project Website; iii) setting up social media accounts on LinkedIn, Twitter, and Facebook; iv) communicating the start of the Project, its developments, activities, and outcomes on the websites of the third-parties (i.e., supporting entities); v) organising webinars for the potential stakeholders introducing the EEO and EOP and the relevant enforcement rules, as well as how to use the IT Platform and the Blockchain System.

The supporting entities play a significant role in the dissemination phase by circulating the Project outcomes among their large audience across the EU, acting as multipliers of the DEUCE awareness raising objective.

To facilitate the circulation of information, the VUB will design a harmonized template (with a letterhead in compliance with the EU rules on visibility of the EU co-funding activities) to be used for all these dissemination activities. This compliance will be also applied to the deliverables.

The Consortium has already a well-established and strong network due to the professional involvement of BENs in various channels, i.e., European Consumer Centres Networks in different MSs; Fédération des Barreaux d'Europe; the European Bailiffs Foundation; and the European Law Institute (ELI). As a result of this strong network, the activities (webinars and the final conference) and outcomes of the DEUCE will be significantly disseminated among the relevant stakeholders without additional costs.

An additional pivotal pillar to widely disseminate the Project among the relevant stakeholders is the strong network of some BENs (**VUB, VU, UniZg, UL, UNINA, TalTech**) with prominent international peer-reviewed journals (e.g., *EuCML Journal*, *the Italian and Spanish Journal of Civil Procedural Law*, *Journal of Private International Law*, etc.) that facilitates a greater distribution of the Project's activities and results among the potential academic and practitioners.

For reaching out the operators and the end-users of EEO and EOP across the Union, all deliverables will be produced in English, except the Roadmap which will be principally produced in English then translated in the national languages of the involved MSs with the aim to facilitate better enforcement of EEO and EOP judgments by national operators and end-users.

The DEUCE Final Conference will be held in English and presents the project outcomes to the interested audience. The event will be live streamed and video-recorded to be later uploaded on various channels (i.e., Project Website and social media accounts, BEN's organisational websites, supporting entities Websites, YouTube, etc.). The uploaded video will be publicly and freely available to reach the maximum capacity for dissemination of the project outcomes and specifically raise awareness of the establishment of the IT Platform and the Blockchain System for the public use.

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3.3 Sustainability and continuation

Sustainability, long-term impact and continuation

Describe the follow-up of the project after the EU funding ends. How will the project impact be ensured and sustained?

What will need to be done? Which parts of the project should be continued or maintained? How will this be achieved? Which resources will be necessary to continue the project? How will the results be used?

Are there any possible synergies/complementarities with other (EU funded) activities that can build on the project results?

The sustainability of the DEUCE impact will be ensured through the: i) IT Platform planned to become a permanent directory providing effective guidance (to end-users/consumers/lawyers/bailiffs/any other potential stakeholder) on the EEO and EOP enforcement rules in the entire 26 MSs. This Platform will be regularly updated even after the project duration; ii) Blockchain System that permanently provides its users with a secure and transparent platform to enforce the obtained EEO and EOP judgments through a facilitated mechanism; iii) Project website, hosted by the VUB server for years after the end of the Project. The fact that the IT platform and the project website will be hosted on VUB servers it will ensure the maintenance and the sustainability in the long term, by the DIKE team of the VUB. Moreover, LinkedIn, Twitter, and Facebook accounts of the Project will be maintained with regular updates about the DEUCE objectives; iv) Roadmap elaborated during the project lifespan will remain as publicly available sources for the potential stakeholders, specifically national and EU policymakers that benefit from these sources in policymaking activities; v) International DEUCE Network with specific focus on simplification and digitalisation of the EEO and EOP enforcement procedures will frequently circulate the Project deliverables to members of the supporting entities. This Network will be actively involved in communicating the results of the Project and any update even after the Project ends. Further, the long-term sustainability of the Project will be guaranteed by BENs' frequent cooperation in updating and improving the contents of the roadmap on the one hand, and the IT Platform and blockchain system on the other resulting in raising awareness and proper functioning of the EEO and EOP enforcement procedures in the EU in spite of the end of the Project.

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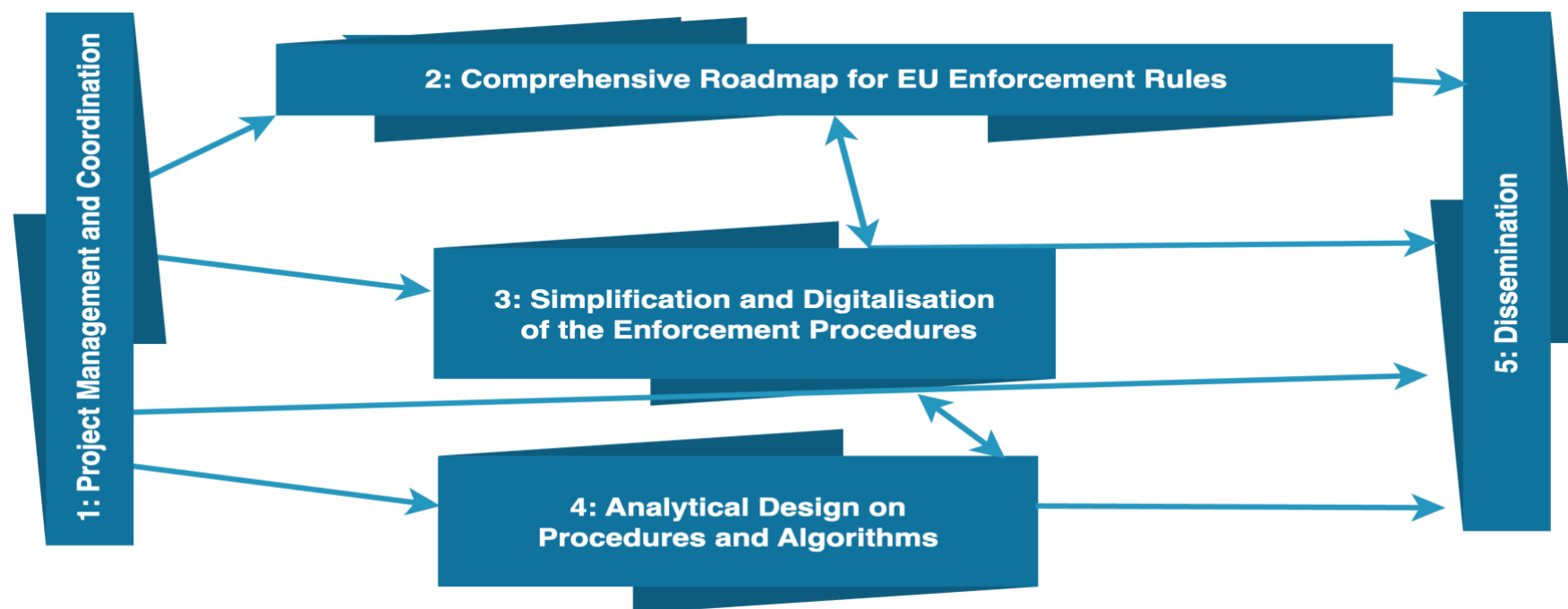
#@WRK-PLA-WP@#

4. WORKPLAN, WORK PACKAGES, ACTIVITIES, RESOURCES AND TIMING

4.1 Work plan

Work plan

Provide a brief description of the overall structure of the work plan (list of work packages or graphical presentation (Pert chart or similar)).



4.2 Work packages, activities, resources and timing

WORK PACKAGES

Work packages

This section concerns a detailed description of the project activities.

*Group your activities into work packages. **A work package means a major sub-division of the project.** For each work package, enter an objective (expected outcome) and list the activities, milestones and deliverables that belong to it. The grouping should be logical and guided by identifiable outputs.*

Projects should normally have a minimum of 2 work packages.

WP1 should cover the management and coordination activities (meetings, coordination, project monitoring and evaluation, financial management, progress reports, etc) and all the activities which are cross-cutting and therefore difficult to assign to another specific work package (do not try splitting these activities across different work packages).

WP2 and further WPs should be used for the other project activities. You can create as many work packages as needed by copying WP2. Please limit the number of work packages to max 6 and the number of deliverables (and their data volume) to max 10 to 15 for the entire project.

Work packages covering financial support to third parties (⚠ only allowed if authorised in the Call document) must describe the conditions for implementing the support (for grants: max amounts per third party; criteria for calculating the exact amounts, types of activity that qualify (closed list), persons/categories of persons to be supported and criteria and procedures for giving support; for prizes: eligibility and award criteria, amount of the prize and payment arrangements).

⚠ Enter each activity/milestone/output/outcome/deliverable only once (under one work package).

⚠ Ensure consistence with the detailed budget table/calculator (if applicable). (n/a for prefixed Lump Sum Grants)

Objectives

List the specific objectives to which the work package is linked.

Activities and division of work (WP description)

Provide a concise overview of the work (planned tasks). Be specific and give a short name and number for each task.

*Show who is participating in each task: Coordinator (COO), Beneficiaries (BEN), Affiliated Entities (AE), Associated Partners (AP), indicating **in bold** the task leader.*

Add information on other participants' involvement in the project e.g. subcontractors, in-kind contributions.

Examples of tasks in WP1: project management/coordination activities, financial management, evaluation activities.

Examples of tasks for WP2 and following (depending on the work package): trainings delivery, seminars/final conference, drafting and advocating policy recommendations, data collection, data analysis, work on training material, social media communication activities, drafting and publishing newsletters.

Note:

In-kind contributions: In-kind contributions for free are cost-neutral, i.e. cannot be declared as cost. Please indicate the in-kind contributions that are provided in the context of this work package

The Coordinator remains fully responsible for the coordination tasks, even if they are delegated to someone else. Coordinator tasks cannot be subcontracted (see Model Grant Agreement).

If there is subcontracting, please also complete the table below.

Milestones and deliverables (outputs/outcomes)

***Milestones** are control points in the project that help to chart progress (e.g. completion of a key deliverable allowing the next phase of the work to begin). Use them only for major outputs in complex projects, otherwise leave the section empty. Please limit the number of milestones by work package.*

Means of verification are how you intend to prove that a milestone has been reached. If appropriate, you can also refer to indicators.

Deliverables are project outputs which are submitted to show project progress (any format). Refer only to major outputs. Do not include minor sub-items or internal working papers, meeting minutes, etc. Limit the number of deliverables (and their data volume) to max 10-15 for the entire project. You may be asked to further reduce the number during grant preparation.

Examples of milestones and deliverables for WP 1:

Milestones - control points in the project that help to chart progress, e.g. signature of the consortium agreement;

Deliverables - transnational/ national coordination meetings, steering committees, evaluation report, progress report to the EU.

Examples of milestones and deliverables for WP 2:

Milestones - control points in the project that help to chart progress (e.g. completion of a major task);

Deliverables - publications, leaflets, trainings, webinars, conferences, seminars, reports, toolkits, manuals.

For deliverables such as meetings, events, seminars, trainings, workshops, webinars, conferences, etc., enter each deliverable separately and provide the following in the 'Description' field: invitation, agenda, signed presence list, target group, number of estimated participants, duration of the event, report of the event, training material package, presentations, evaluation report, feedback questionnaire.

For deliverables such as manuals, toolkits, guides, reports, leaflets, brochures, training materials etc., add in the 'Description' field: format (electronic or printed), language(s), approximate number of pages and estimated number of copies of publications (if any).

For each deliverable you will have to indicate a due month by when you commit to upload it in the Portal. The due month of the deliverable cannot be outside the duration of the work package and must be in line with the timeline provided below. Month 1 marks the start of the project and all deadlines should be related to this starting date.

The labels used mean:

Public — fully open (🚩 automatically posted online on the Project Results platforms)

Sensitive — limited under the conditions of the Grant Agreement

EU classified — RESTREINT-UE/EU-RESTRICTED, CONFIDENTIEL-UE/EU-CONFIDENTIAL, SECRET-UE/EU-SECRET under Decision [2015/444](#). For items classified under other rules (e.g. national or international organisation), please select the equivalent EU classification level.

Work Package 1

Work Package 1: Project management and coordination				
Duration:	M1 – M2	Lead Beneficiary:	VUB	
Objectives				
Ensuring coordination of and among partners' activity; ensuring efficient implementation of the Project activity; supporting partners in maintaining clear audible financial accounts; monitoring and evaluating the implementation of Project activities.				
Activities and division of work (WP description)				
Task No	Task Name	Description	Participants	

(continuous numbering linked to WP)			Name	Role (COO, BEN, AE, AP, OTHER)	In-kind Contributions and Subcontracting (Yes/No and which)
1.1	General coordination	Convene and manage kick-off and periodical coordination meetings	VUB	COO	NO
1.2	Steering Committee	During the kick-off meeting (KOM) the Project Steering Committee (SC) will be appointed (co-chairs Giacalone and Van Der Borgh + Team Leaders of each BEN).	VUB + all BENs	COO, BEN	NO
1.3	Project Management	Along the Project, VUB will support all BENs in the technical implementation of their tasks and circulate guidelines specifying all the actions and documents required for the purpose of implementing and reporting the planned activities and correctly and efficiently managing the funds	Giacalone + VUB + BENs' respective administrative staff	COO, BEN	NO
1.4	Data Management Plan	The task will describe the data management life cycle for the data to be processed throughout the project. This will include information on the handling of research data during & after the project; the type of data processed; the methodology and standards that will be applied; which data will be shared/made open access and how data will be stored (including after project end).	VUB	COO	NO
1.5	Consortium Agreement	Drafting the consortium agreement, with the assistance of internal legal officers; circulating drafts to partners, agreeing on the final text, signing	VUB + all BENs' internal legal officers	COO, BEN	NO
1.6	Appointing the AAB, CEPE and EC	According to Section 2.5 (see above)	VUB + all BENs	BEN, COO	NO

1.7	Recruitment of Researchers, Project Management Assistant and External Professional Evaluator	Following the procedures required for that purpose at national level.	VUB + all BENs	COO, BEN	NO		
Milestones and deliverables (outputs/outcomes)							
Milestone No (continuous numbering not linked to WP)	Milestone Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Description	Due Date (month number)	Means of Verification	
MS1	Kick-off meeting and Periodical coordination meetings	1	VUB	Agendas & Minutes of the meetings and KOM	1, 4, 7, 10, 13, 16, 19, 22	Skype/MS Teams meetings convened to coordinate Project activities	
MS2	Steering Committee	1	VUB	Agenda & Minutes of the KOM	1	Co-chairs Giacalone & Van Der Borgh. + 1 member per BEN	
Deliverable No (continuous numbering linked to WP)	Deliverable Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Type	Dissemination Level	Due Date (month number)	Description (including format and language)
D1.1	Data Management Plan Report	1	VUB	R — Document, report	Public	3	Document, PDF, National languages
D1.2	Mid-term Report	1	VUB	R — Document, report	Confidential	12	Document following EU Commission's template, PDF, English
D1.3	AAB, CEPE and EC Reports	1	VUB	R — Document, report	Public	24	Report, PDF, English

Work Package 2

Work Package 2: Comprehensive Roadmap for EU Enforcement Rules (EOP and EEO Judgements)					
Duration:	M1- M10	Lead Beneficiary:	VU		
Objectives					
- Verify the use of the procedure, its enforcement and identify the types of issues encountered at enforcement level; compare national experiences and check whether the application of the EEO and EOP enforcement rules is uniform throughout the EU; - Collect national enforcement rules on the EEO and EOP judgments execution					
Activities and division of work (WP description)					
Task No (continuous numbering linked to WP)	Task Name	Description	Participants		In-kind Contributions and Subcontracting (Yes/No and which)
			Name	Role (COO, BEN, AE, AP, OTHER)	
2.1	Collecting data on national enforcement rules for the EEO and EOP enforcement	Conducting research to collect data on MSs enforcement rules of EEO and EOP judgments. The field of research covers the whole of the EU. The Member States are thus divided among the partners of the DEUCE Consortium: VUB for BE, ES, NL, FI; UniZg for HR, CZ, PL, HU; UL for SI, SK, BG, CY; VU for LT, MT, LV, EE; Adiconsum for IT, RO, PT, SE, EUBF for FR, IE, LU, EL; and ZEVI for AT, DE.	ALL	COO, BEN	NO
2.2	Comparative and Analytical Study of Best Practices	Composing an analytical report comparing best practices of enforcing rules of EEO and EOP judgments, and specifically addressing practice as to cross-border cooperation among national operators in the field of enforcement of judgments	ALL	COO, BEN	NO

2.3	Creating the Roadmap on the EU Enforcement Rules of EEO and EOP Judgments	Compiling a comprehensive Roadmap that will contain the enforcement rules of the 26 MSs in enforcing EEO and EOP judgments based on the collected national data.	VUB + UniZg – UL – VU – EUBF – Adiconsum – ZEV	COO, BEN	NO		
Milestones and deliverables (outputs/outcomes)							
Milestone No (continuous numbering not linked to WP)	Milestone Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Description	Due Date (month number)	Means of Verification	
MS3	Pursuing a Comparative and Analytical Study of Best Practices	2	VU	The Comparative and Analytical Study to identify the best practices of EEO and EOP judgments enforcement that will contain the results of the data collection carried out at national level by the individual partners.	10	Unitary collection of national EEO and EOP enforcement rules as collected by partners at national level leading to the Comparative and Analytical Study of best practices	
MS4	Creation of the Roadmap on the EU Enforcement Rules of EEO and EOP Judgments	2	VUB	The comprehensive Roadmap that will contain the EEO and EOP enforcement rules of the 26 MSs and will be produced based on the collected national data.	10	This Roadmap contains all the EEO and EOP enforcement rules in different MSs across the EU	
Deliverable No (continuous numbering linked to WP)	Deliverable Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Type	Dissemination Level	Due Date (month number)	Description (including format and language)
D2.1	Comparative and Analytical Study of Best Practices	2	VU	R — Document	Public	10	Comparative and Analytical Study of Best Practices for the national enforcement rules of the EEO and EOP judgments, PDF, English

D2.2	Roadmap for EU Enforcement Rules on EEO and EOP Judgments	2	VUB	R — Document	Public	10	Roadmap for the national enforcement rules of the EEO and EOP judgments, PDF, English (national language when appropriate)
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Work Package3

Work Package 3: Simplification and Digitalisation of the Enforcement Procedures			
Duration:	M3- M24	Lead Beneficiary:	UNINA
Objectives			
This WP is devoted to simplifying and facilitating access to procedures for the resolution of monetary claims. Improving the simplification and digitalisation of enforcement procedures implies enhancing efficiency, transparency, accessibility, data management mechanisms and, where possible, reducing bureaucracy. In this WP, we will design, implement and validate a platform that combines artificial intelligence and information technology techniques in general, to simplify, streamline and schematise monetary claims procedures. In particular, the aim of this WP will be the realisation of a system that will allow users, mediators, lawyers and judges to follow a workflow of operations in which the various actors (users, lawyers, judges...) will be able to enter and obtain information, make choices based on the information received, perform actions and communicate with other users through a user-friendly interface. An Intelligent Interface will guide users throughout the procedure, leading them towards the most appropriate legislation and best practices, outputting relevant information and suggesting operations based on the context. The various actors will be able to communicate without being physically present at the same table, carrying out stages of the procedure in different places and at different times, in compliance with timetables and deadlines. The system will be web-based, deployed on the cloud, and accessible without any installation operation from PC, Smartphone and Tablet. Data exchange will rely on the blockchain information management paradigm that ensures the immutability, security and traceability of data. The objectives of this WP are: O3.1) The development of a system that implements a workflow that best schematizes the interactions of the different types of users involved in the monetary claim process, harmonizing the procedure across different countries; O3.2)The Integration with an intelligent user interface that gives ad hoc explanations and appropriately proposes relevant legislation and best practices; O3.3)The adoption of the blockchain paradigm for exchanging information in a transparent, secure and traceable manner, across different European countries.			
Activities and division of work (WP description)			

Task No (continuous numbering linked to WP)	Task Name	Description	Participants		In-kind Contributions and Subcontracting (Yes/No and which)
			Name	Role (COO, BEN, AE, AP, OTHER)	
3.1	Ad-hoc Designed Workflow for monetary claim procedure	In this task, we define the workflow optimised for the monetary claim resolution process. The sequence of steps will be designed to lead to an agreement with the least possible expenditure of resources, i.e. the smallest number of steps, in the shortest time and at the lowest cost. The defined workflow must also be robust and flexible to any changes and conditions that may occur and to the different scenarios. This task implies the identification of the key tasks involved in the monetary claims resolution process (that can include filing a claim, serving the defendant, gathering evidence, preparing for the hearing, and presenting the case). We will share the diagram that outlines the entire process, helping to visualize the whole process and identify any potential areas for improvement, in order to facilitate the synergy among computer and legal domain experts.	UNINA+ Legal Units	BEN	No
3.2	Semantic Processing and Human in the Loop Machine/Deep Learning Procedure over the domain documentations	In this task, we will focus on the intelligent interface accompanying the workflow system for the resolution of economic claims. At this aim, we design human-in-the-loop machine/deep learning and reasoning procedures focused on extracting, uniform and structuring information taken by pertinent legal	UNINA+ Legal Units		

		corpora and datasets available on relevant dispute resolution topics. The processed corpora, both open data and proprietary format, contains relevant legislation, case studies and best practices. In this task, we develop algorithms for reading the queries and the information requests that can be inserted from the users and link those with the proper, correct answers related and linked with the relevant sections of the corpora. For users involved in cross-border cases who need to consult legal documents in a different language, the algorithm developed will also link the user queries with corpora in a foreign language.			
3.3	Intelligent Interface Model Build and Validation (M6-M24)	The intelligent interface will be able to give relevant answers on the legal domain, not generalist ones, as it has an appropriate knowledge base trained on domain documentation. In particular, the knowledge base is composed of different models. We build transformer models by exploiting attention mechanism to tackle the sequence data using the state of the art of deep learning for NLP. We also build an ontology-based model to formalise the legal expert knowledge in the standard OWL/RDF language. The system, powered by these models, will produce domain answers depending on the queries inserted by the user. All partners will be responsible for feeding the domain dataset on which the model will be trained. The use of annotation tool technology supports metadata extraction. It guarantees the production of high-quality datasets for the Model Definition and allows Model Validation against real case studies.	UNINA+ Legal Units		

		In addition, we evaluate the performance of the trained model using a separate dataset to ensure that the model can generalise to new data and is not overfitted to the training data.			
3.4	Blockchain Integration for data exchanging mechanism	We integrate Blockchain technology for data sharing in the Platform for the economic claim. By using a blockchain, the Platform can be considered a decentralized system that allows multiple parties to share data in a secure and transparent way without the need for a central authority. The blockchain can serve as a ledger that records all user transactions. By using cryptographic techniques, such as public-key cryptography, data can be shared securely and verified by other participants of the Platform. The integration of blockchain technology for data sharing in the Platform will provide greater transparency, security, and efficiency compared to traditional centralized systems. By leveraging the power of decentralization and cryptography, blockchain can create a trustless environment where participants can share data and assets.	TalTech and UNINA	BEN	No

3.5	Implementation of the platform for monetary claim procedures	<i>This task focused on implementing a platform for monetary claim procedures finalised to streamline the claims process, reduce errors and delays, and improve the overall efficiency and effectiveness of the procedure.</i> <i>We perform requirements elicitation by interviews with partners and final users, use cases and scenarios analyses.</i> <i>We develop the platform so that it meets the requirements of the monetary claim procedure and is scalable, secure, and easy to use for both final users and the administrators who will be processing the claims.</i> <i>We integrate the platform with databases of relevant data, such as claimant information or financial data.</i> <i>We design and implement the intelligent user interface to guide the user step by step throughout the claim process. The interface will be user-friendly, intuitive and easy to use for claimants, administrators, and any other stakeholders involved in the monetary claim procedure.</i>	UNINA		
3.6	Validation and Deployment of the Platform for monetary claim procedure	The validation of the platform for monetary claim procedure involves a series of tests and evaluations to ensure that the platform meets the desired requirements and performs as expected. We will address any issues or bugs identified during testing before the platform is deployed, ensuring that the platform is effective, reliable, and meets the needs of all stakeholders involved in the monetary claim procedure. We test the platform with end-users to ensure that it is easy to use and meets their needs. During the task, we collect feedback from users through surveys and focus groups. We verify the platform's security to ensure that it protects sensitive information and is not	UNINA		

		vulnerable to attacks or data breaches. In particular, we test the platform's authentication and authorisation mechanisms, as well as its encryption and data protection features. We test the platform's compliance with relevant laws, regulations, and standards, such as data privacy laws and specific rules. Finally, we test the platform's usability and user experience to ensure that it is easy to navigate, intuitive, and meets the needs of end-users. At the end of the task a consolidated version of the solution will be delivered, which we will make exploitable beyond the end of the project.				
Milestones and deliverables (outputs/outcomes)						
Milestone No (continuous numbering not linked to WP)	Milestone Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Description	Due Date (month number)	Means of Verification
MS5	Intelligent Interface guiding users throughout the procedure	3	UNINA	Validation via user-feedback: the feedback collection process will include interactive questionnaires, usage reports and as well as one-to-one discussions with the users, user workshops, and information gathering when performing technical support for the users.	12	.This milestone describes the platform for monetary claim procedure integrated with Intelligent Interface guiding users throughout the procedure.

MS6	Blockchain-based platform to support monetary claim procedure	3	UNINA	Validation via user-feedback: the feedback collection process will include interactive questionnaires, usage reports and as well as one-to-one discussions with the users, user workshops, and information gathering when performing technical support for the users.		24	This milestone describes the platform for monetary claim procedure integrated with blockchain component.
Deliverable No (continuous numbering linked to WP)	Deliverable Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Type	Dissemination Level	Due Date (month number)	Description (including format and language)
D3.1	Workflow for monetary claim procedure	3	UNINA	R-document	PU - Public	10	<i>Description of the optimised workflow, ad-hoc designed for the monetary claim resolution process.</i>
D3.2	System Architecture of the platform for monetary claim procedure	3	UNINA	R-document	CO - Confidential	12	Description of the System Architecture of the platform, including the composing the intelligent and the blockchain components.

D3.3	Semantic Processing and ML/DL procedures the Intelligent Interface design	3	UNINA	R-document	PU - Public	20	Description of the Semantic Processing and Human in the Loop Machine and Deep Learning Procedure over the domain documentations adopted for the implementation of the Intelligent Interface of the Platform
D3.4	Monitoring and evaluation of the validation activities	3	UNINA	R-document	PU - Public	22	This deliverable will document and evaluate the CROCUS testing and validation activities within the available use-cases.
D3.5	Intelligent and Blockchain-based platform to support monetary claim procedure	3	UNINA	[OTHER]	PU - Public	24	This is the final version of the online Platform. The Platform will be accessible via web also beyond the end of the project.

Work Package 4

Work Package 4: Analytical Design on Procedures and Algorithms			
Duration:	M1 – M24	Lead Beneficiary:	TaITech
Objectives			
List the specific objectives to which this work package is linked.			
Applying AI-driven tools, machine learning. Implementation of Smart-contract Blockchain Technology based on DApp Design methodology for the certified agreement between the parties. (WP3)			

Activities (what, how, where) and division of work

Provide a concise overview of the work (planned tasks). Be specific and give a short name and number for each task.

Show who is participating in each task: Coordinator (COO), Beneficiaries (BEN), Affiliated Entities (AE), Associated Partners (AP), indicating **in bold** the task leader.

Add information on other participants' involvement in the project e.g. subcontractors, in-kind contributions.

Examples of tasks (depending on the work package): trainings delivery, seminars/final conference, drafting and advocating policy recommendations, data collection, data analysis, work on training material, social media communication activities, drafting and publishing newsletters.

Note:

In-kind contributions: In-kind contributions for free are cost-neutral, i.e. cannot be declared as cost. Please indicate the in-kind contributions that are provided in the context of this work package.

The coordinator remains fully responsible for the coordination tasks, even if they are delegated to someone else. Coordinator tasks can normally not be subcontracted (see Model Grant Agreement).

If there is subcontracting, please also complete the table in section 4.3.

Task No (continuous numbering linked to WP)	Task Name	Description	Participant		In-kind Contributions and Subcontracting (Yes/No and which)
			Name	Role (COO, BEN, AE, AP, OTHER)	
4.1	Developing the requirement models	Using functional decomposition deduce functional and non-functional (technical) requirements for the system. User requirements, or functional requirements refer to the immediate functionality of the system, its capabilities and ways to interact with it. At this stage system is treated as black box (thus, implementation details are obscured). Non-functional, technical, or system requirements are developed in order to transform user capability(user) requirements into concrete and specific requirements, when system is treated as gray box, where some details of system internals are present, along with restrictions imposed on the system from the beginning.	TalTech	BEN	No

4.2	Specifying the inter-organizational collaboration processes	Study and development of flowcharts for processes occurring in the system. Processes should be detailed and broken down to the level when each individual step (node in the flowchart/graph) corresponds to the individual (or a set of) user requirements. The flowchart to be presented would be either an UML Activity diagram or IDEF/BPMN diagrams.	Ta/Tech	BEN	NO		
4.3	Deducing the system architecture	Based on the modern design principles, the system's architecture is proposed. System is to be described statically, when component boundaries are understood, and some internals are described. Component interfaces are to be defined at this stage.	Ta/Tech	BEN	No		
4.4	Embed the component diagram into an inter-organizational reference architecture	Based on static system architecture and the Business Process chart from 4.2, system is described in greater detail, where not only static interfaces are defined, but interoperability of the various systems components.	Ta/Tech	BEN	No		
4.5	Dynamic protocol specification	Dynamic system behaviour is defined. Interfaces, REST APIs are specified, and component internal and external behaviour is tied together.	Ta/Tech	BEN	No		
4.6	Developing a technology stack	A set of technologies is proposed based on current trends, technologies available, industry standard solutions and requirements of the system. The technology stack addresses the question of how the system should be implemented and which tools shall we used for which function.	Ta/Tech	BEN	No		
4.7	Implementation and deployment	The system is implemented based on the models and determined technology stack. The final deployment must consider an integration with pre-existing respective legacy systems.	Ta/Tech	BEN	No		
Milestone No		Milestone Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Means of Verification	Due Date	Description

<i>(continuous numbering not linked to WP)</i>						<i>(month number)</i>	
MS7	Blockchain system	4	TalTech	The report due at month 22		24	Development of new blockchain system suitable for the DEUCE software
<i>Deliverable No (continuous numbering linked to WP)</i>	<i>Deliverable Name</i>	<i>Work Package No</i>	<i>Lead Beneficiary</i>	<i>Type</i>	<i>Dissemination Level</i>	<i>Due Date (month number)</i>	<i>Description (including format and language)</i>
D4.1	Requirement model	4	TalTech	R – document	Confidential	2	Word/PDF document in EN
D4.2	IO-BPM	4	TalTech	R – document	Confidential	3	Word/PDF document in EN
D4.3	Architecture	4	TalTech	R – document	Confidential	5	Word/PDF document in EN
D4.4	eSRA integration	4	TalTech	R – document	Confidential	6	Word/PDF document in EN
D4.5	Dynamic protocol	4	TalTech	R – document	Confidential	10	Word/PDF document in EN
D4.6	Technology stack	4	TalTech	R-document	confidential	12	Word/PDF document in EN
D4.7	Development	4	TalTech	R-document	confidential	24	Word/PDF document in EN

Work Package 5**Work Package 5: Dissemination**

Duration:	M1 - M24	Lead Beneficiary:	VUB		
Objectives					
List the specific objectives to which this work package is linked.					
Spreading awareness and trust in the EEO and EOP and the enforcement of its judgments across the EU, disseminating the Project outcomes					
Activities (what, how, where) and division of work					
Provide a concise overview of the work (planned tasks). Be specific and give a short name and number for each task.					
Show who is participating in each task: Coordinator (COO), Beneficiaries (BEN), Affiliated Entities (AE), Associated Partners (AP), indicating in bold the task leader.					
Add information on other participants' involvement in the project e.g. subcontractors, in-kind contributions.					
Examples of tasks (depending on the work package): trainings delivery, seminars/final conference, drafting and advocating policy recommendations, data collection, data analysis, work on training material, social media communication activities, drafting and publishing newsletters.					
Note:					
In-kind contributions: In-kind contributions for free are cost-neutral, i.e. cannot be declared as cost. Please indicate the in-kind contributions that are provided in the context of this work package.					
The coordinator remains fully responsible for the coordination tasks, even if they are delegated to someone else. Coordinator tasks can normally not be subcontracted (see Model Grant Agreement).					
If there is subcontracting, please also complete the table in section 4.3.					
Task No (continuous numbering linked to WP)	Task Name	Description	Participant		In-kind Contributions and Subcontracting (Yes/No and which)
			Name	Role (COO, BEN, AE, AP, OTHER)	

5.1	Project Leaflet	Drafting a leaflet providing details on the Project scope, objectives and foreseen activities and deliverables, to promote Project awareness among the operators and the end-users	VUB	COO	NO
5.2	Project Website	A Website where all the public deliverables will be uploaded and freely available for all stakeholders, also where the Project activities and results will be published.	VUB + TalTech	COO + BEN	NO
5.3	LinkedIn, Twitter, Facebook Accounts	Social media accounts that will publish all the frequent updates concerning the Project activities, public deliverables, news and publications on the EEO and EOP.	VUB	COO	NO
5.4	Newsletter Articles	Publishing 4 newsletter articles targeting consumers to increase their awareness of the EEO and EOP and its enforcement rules across the EU.	Adiconsum	BEN	NO
5.5	Journal Publications	Publishing two scientific papers in renowned international peer-reviewed journals (i.e., European Journal of International law, Journal of Law and Information Technology, Maastricht Journal of European and Comparative Law) on the addressed issues in the DEUCE Project. While the first paper will specifically focus on analysing the implementation and specifically enforcement of the EEO and EOP judgments in EU, the focal point of the second paper will be on the methodology, theoretical and empirical studies conducted during the Project underlying the simplification and digitalisation of the EEO and EOP enforcement process.	VUB + UniZg, TalTech	COO + BEN	NO
5.6	Webinars	A key sub activity under this task is the set-up and hosting of invited webinars, for the potential operators and the end-users. Using GoToMeeting, or a similar teleconference platform, the partners will facilitate 5 one-hour webinars to present the EEO and EOP and the enforcement rules of the EEO and EOP judgments, also introducing the designed IT Platform and the Blockchain System, walk potential users through these, and address any questions they might have.	VUB, VU, Adiconsum, UL, UniZg	COO + BEN	NO

5.7	Project Final Conference	VUB will organize a Final Conference, involving all BENs and supporting entities to further disseminate the final Project outcomes and increase awareness on the EEO and EOP and its enforcement rules.	VUB	COO	NO
5.8	DEUCE Network	Institutionalization of a network of lawyers, bailiffs, consumer associations involved in the application of the EEO and EOP and its enforcement procedures, also academics.	VUB + all BEN	COO + BEN	NO

Milestones and deliverables (outputs/outcomes)

Milestones are control points in the project that help to chart progress. They may correspond to the completion of a key deliverable allowing the next phase of the work to begin. Use them only for major outputs in complex projects. Please limit the number of milestones by work package.

Means of verification are how you intend to prove that a milestone has been reached. If appropriate, you can also refer to indicators.

Deliverables are project outputs which are submitted to show project progress (any format). Refer only to major outputs. Do not include minor sub-items or internal working papers, draft versions of materials or minutes. etc. Limit the number of deliverables (and its data volume) to max 10-15 for the entire project. You may be asked to further reduce the number during grant preparation.

Examples of milestones and deliverables for work package 2:

Milestones - control points in the project that help to chart progress (e.g. completion of a major task);

Deliverables - publications, leaflets, trainings, webinars, conferences, seminars, reports, toolkits, manuals.

For deliverables such as meetings, events, seminars, trainings, workshops, webinars, conferences, etc., enter each deliverable separately and provide the following in the 'Description' field: invitation, agenda, signed presence list, target group, number of estimated participants, duration of the event, report of the event, training material package, presentations, evaluation report, feedback questionnaire.

For deliverables such as manuals, toolkits, guides, reports, leaflets, brochures, training materials etc., add in the 'Description' field: format (electronic or printed), language(s), approximate number of pages and estimated number of copies of publications (if any).

For each deliverable you will have to indicate a due month by when you commit to upload it in the Portal. The due month of the deliverable cannot be outside the duration of the work package and must be in line with the timeline provided below. Month 1 marks the start of the project and all deadlines should be related to this starting date.

The labels used mean:

Public — fully open (e.g. web), with possibility to be published and publicly disseminated, including by the EC

Sensitive — limited under the conditions of the Grant Agreement

<i>EU classified —RESTREINT-UE/EU-RESTRICTED, CONFIDENTIEL-UE/EU-CONFIDENTIAL, SECRET-UE/EU-SECRET under Decision <u>2015/444</u>.</i>							
<i>Milestone No</i> <i>(continuous numbering not linked to WP)</i>	<i>Milestone Name</i>	<i>Work Package No</i>	<i>Lead Beneficiary</i>	<i>Means of Verification</i>		<i>Due Date</i> <i>(month number)</i>	<i>Description</i>
MS8	Project Website	5	VUB + TalTech	Publication of the Website, number of visits		4	Website providing information on the Project + all public deliverables
MS9	DEUCE Network	5	VUB + all BENS	Number of members and MS of origin		24	Group of stakeholders throughout EU
<i>Deliverable No</i> <i>(continuous numbering linked to WP)</i>	<i>Deliverable Name</i>	<i>Work Package No</i>	<i>Lead Beneficiary</i>	<i>Type</i>	<i>Dissemination Level</i>	<i>Due Date</i> <i>(month number)</i>	<i>Description</i> <i>(including format and language)</i>
D5.1	Project Leaflet	5	VUB	DEC —leaflet	Public	3	Leaflet, PDF & printed, English (+ national languages of each Partner)
D5.2	Project Website	5	VUB + TalTech	DEC —Website	Public	4	Website, hosted on VUB's server, English
D5.3	LinkedIn, Twitter, and Facebook Accounts	5	VUB	DEC —Social media profile	Public	1	3 Social media profiles, English (+ national language where appropriate)
D5.4	Newsletter Articles	5	Adiconsum + ZEV	R – Document, report	Public	6,12, 18, 24	4 newsletter articles, Italian/English/German
D5.5	Journal publications	5	VUB + UniZg, TalTech	R – Document, report	Public	24	Two Articles in peer-reviewed academic journals, English

D5.6	Reports on Webinars	5	VUB + VU, Adiconsum, UL, UniZg	R – Document, report	Public	24	5 one-hour webinars, min. 50 attendees (lawyers/bailiffs/consumer associations) per webinar, English and national language of each BEN
D5.7	Project Final Conference	5	VUB	OTHER – conference	Public	24	1 day, 120 attendees (of whom min. 40 lawyers, 30 bailiffs, 10 representative of consumers association, 5 policymakers, 5 judges, 30 academics, , posters and brochures, audiovideo-recording system, catering, hostesses, pre-conference dinner, travel and accommodation signed presence list, PPTs presentations, satisfaction questionnaires.
D5.8	DEUCE Network	5	VUB + all BENs	DEC – mailing list	Confidential	24	Mailing-list (electronic), min. 500 members (including, min. 200 lawyers, 200 bailiffs, 20 consumer associations, 80 academics)

Staff effort (n/a for Lump Sum Grants)

Subcontracting (n/a for prefixed Lump Sum Grants)

Timetable

DEUCE Project GANTT chart																									
Task Name	Task Resp.	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6	M7	M8	M9	M10	M11	M12	M13	M14	M15	M16	M17	M18	M19	M20	M21	M22	M23	M24
WP1: Project management & coordination																									
General coordination	VUB	♦ D1.2																							
Steering Committee	VUB	♦																							
Project Management	VUB																								
Data Management plan	VUB	D1.1																					D1.2		
Consortium Agreement	VUB																								
Appointing AAB CEPE & EC	VUB	D1.3																							
Recruitment	VUB																								
WP2: Comprehensive Roadmap for EU Enforcement Rules																									
Collecting data on national enforcement rules for EEO and EOP	VU																								
Comparative and Analytical Study of Best Practices	VU										♦D2.1														
Creating the Roadmap on the EU Enforcement Rules of EEO and EOP	VUB										♦D2.2														
WP3: Simplification and Digitalisation of the Enforcement Procedures																									
Ad-hoc Designed Workflow for monetary claim procedure	UNINA										D3.1														
Semantic Processing and Human in the Loop	UNINA																								D3.2
Intelligent Interface Model Build and Validation	UNINA																				♦				
Integration of blockchain and simplified procedure	UNINA												♦D3.3												
Implementation of the platform	UNINA																						D3.4		
Validation and Deployment	UNINA																								D3.5
WP4: Analytical Design on Procedures and Algorithms																									
Developing the requirement models	TaITech		D4.1																						
Specifying the inter-organizational collaboration processes	TaITech			D4.2																					
Deducing the system architecture	TaITech					D4.3																			
Embed component diagram into an inter-org. reference architecture	TaITech						D4.4																		
Dynamic protocol specification	TaITech										D4.5														
Developing a technology stack	TaITech												D4.6												
Implementation and deployment	TaITech																							♦D4.7	
WP5: Dissemination																									
Project Leaflet	VUB			D5.1																					
Project Website	VUB																								♦D5.2
LinkedIn, Twitter, Facebook Accounts	VUB																								D5.3
Newsletter Articles	Adiconsum																								D5.4
Journal Publications	VUB																								D5.5
Webinars	Adiconsum																								D5.6
Project Final Conference	VUB																								D5.7
DEUCE Network	VUB																								♦D5.8

Caption: W: Workpackage, D: Deliverables ♦: Milestones

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5. OTHER

5.1 Ethics and EU values

Ethics and EU values

Describe ethics issues that may arise during the project implementation and the measures you intend to take to solve/avoid them.

Describe how you will ensure gender and non-discrimination mainstreaming in the project cycle. This means integrating gender equality and non-discrimination considerations in the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of project activities. Projects activities should be pro-active and contribute to the equal empowerment of women and men, girls and boys, in all their diversity, and ensure that they achieve their full potential, enjoy the same rights and opportunities. Gender and non-discrimination mainstreaming are a key mechanism for achieving gender equality and combating multiple and intersecting discrimination. In the delivery of project activities gender mainstreaming shall be ensured by systematically monitoring access, participation, and benefits among different genders, and by incorporating remedial action that redresses any gender inequalities and discriminatory effects in implementation of planned activities. The activities shall also seek to reduce levels of discrimination suffered by particular groups (as well as those at risk of multiple discrimination) and to improve equality outcomes for individuals.

If your project has a direct or indirect impact on children and their rights, indicate it clearly here. Make sure that your project is based on a child rights approach, i.e. that all the rights of the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights and the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC) and the Optional protocols, are promoted, respected, protected and fulfilled. The project should address children as rights holders and should ensure their participation in the design and implementation of the project. If you will have direct contacts with children you will have to provide a child protection policies in line with the [Keeping Children Safe Child Safeguarding Standards](#).

Explain how you intend to address privacy/data protection issues related to data collection, analysis and dissemination.

Outline measures to be taken and the policies in place to guarantee full compliance with the EU values mentioned in Article 2 of the Treaty on the European Union and Article 21 of the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights.

The activities of the projects will comply with the highest ethical standards and applicable international, EU, and national law (in particular, the principles and values enshrined in the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights and the EU Treaties). The DEUCE consortium will specifically consider the gender mainstreaming rules (in accordance with Art. 119 of Treaty of Rome 1957; Art. 2&3 of Amsterdam Treaty 1997; Art. 2&3 TEU; Art. 8&10 TFEU Lisbon Treaty 2009; and UN Beijing Conference on Women 1995) to ensure the project is gender-responsive (e.g., through using gender-neutral language, the inclusion of women in conducting managerial tasks, etc). This strategy will enable the consortium to mitigate the risks of any gender inequalities and encourage the full participation of women in the entire implementation of the project. This will be ensured in several ways.

WP1 will create a project Ethics Committee (p. 11), which will be in charge of ensuring compliance of all activities with the ethics requirements set out by the European Commission. As such, the Project Ethics Committee will continuously collect the necessary information and monitor the project work. If deviations are identified from the defined principles, feedback will be given to the relevant partners for mandatory adjustments. Also, the Ethics Committee will ensure that GDPR guidelines are implemented. It will define the processes and provide templates for internal project ethical application forms and informed consent forms in the cases in that humans will be involved. Gender and equity issues will be monitored to guarantee equal (to the maximum extent) representation of genders, age groups, disabilities, and socio-economic backgrounds. DEUCE project will conduct surveys, focus groups and interviews, which could raise ethical issues. To make sure this is not the case, information sheets and informed consent forms will be used to inform participants about the scope and aim of the study and to collect the consent of the participants, with the help of the Ethics Committee.

WP1 will conduct a Data Management Plan (due M3) early on that ensures an appropriate level of protection of fundamental rights. The process of collecting legal documents, which could include personal data, will be organised in a way that follows data protection requirements (e.g., legal basis, security of the process).

In DEUCE project, the partners involved will, moreover, use the Assessment List for Trustworthy Artificial Intelligence (ALTAI) to develop procedures to detect, assess the level, and address potential risks.

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5.2 Security

Security

Design principles, such as “Security by Design”, “Privacy by Design”, and “Privacy by Default”, and suitable mechanisms for encryption, authentication, and authorisation (e.g. TLS protocol, Single-Sign-On implementations, Policy Enforcement Point for XACML) will be exploited in the DEUCE processes, so as to ensure the satisfaction of core security and data protection requirements, namely confidentiality, integrity, and availability. Researchers are trained in applying the safeguards. DEUCE will facilitate access to information and encourage virtual exchange (through our interactive platform) with a public and one or more restricted areas where to store confidential information for the different stakeholders, according to the EU-GDPR prescriptions. Due to security and data protection reasons, publicly available information will include research results as aggregate pseudonymised data. The amount of publicity and confidentiality given to the project outputs and deliverables would be discussed between the Consortium and the EC in advance and, if wished, appropriate communication actions could be planned. According to the “H2020 Guidance - How to complete your ethics self-assessment” and to the “Guidance - Guidelines for the classification of information in research projects” of 7 January 2020, DEUCE will NOT involve: activities or results raising security issues; ‘EU-classified information’ as background or results. In light of the characteristics of the project, security issues that will need further scrutiny have not been observed. Information collected and analysed during the project lifespan shall not be ‘classified’ neither from the ‘subject-matter of the research’ point of view, nor on the basis of the ‘type of the research/results’. The unauthorised disclosure of data could not adversely affect the interests of the EU or of its MSs. Therefore, there is no actual need to comply with the EU Commission’s security rules and standards because DEUCE handles unclassified information only.

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6. DECLARATIONS

Double funding	
Information concerning other EU grants for this project  Please note that there is a strict prohibition of double funding from the EU budget (except under EU Synergies actions).	YES/NO
We confirm that to our best knowledge neither the project as a whole nor any parts of it have benefitted from any other EU grant (including EU funding managed by authorities in EU Member States or other funding bodies, e.g. EU Regional Funds, EU Agricultural Funds, etc). If NO, explain and provide details.	YES
We confirm that to our best knowledge neither the project as a whole nor any parts of it are (nor will be) submitted for any other EU grant (including EU funding managed by authorities in EU Member States or other funding bodies, e.g. EU Regional Funds, EU Agricultural Funds, etc). If NO, explain and provide details.	YES

Financial support to third parties

If in your project the maximum amount per third party will be more than the threshold amount set in the Call document, justify and explain why the higher amount is necessary in order to fulfil your project’s objectives.

N/A

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